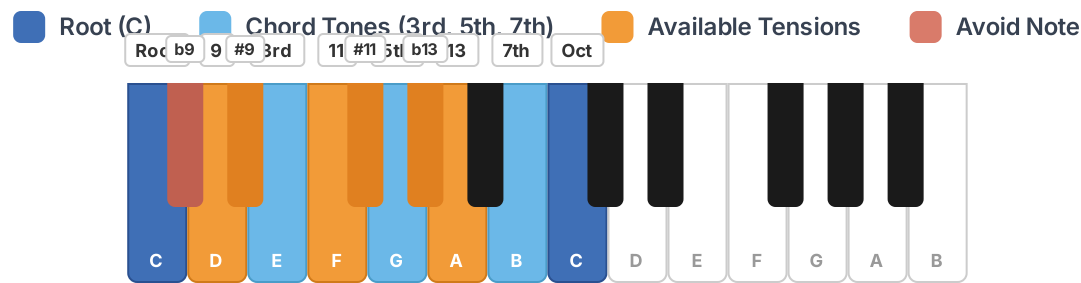


TENSIONS — THE FULL MAP

Every upper extension from root C — where they live on the keyboard and how to identify them instantly.



THE WHOLE-STEP RULE

WHOLE STEP above a chord tone = **Available Tension** ✓

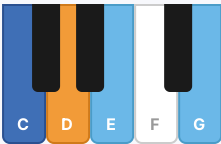
HALF STEP above a chord tone = **Avoid Note** ✗

This single test tells you whether any note in the key is safe to add to any chord — instantly, without memorization.

THE RULE IN ACTION — TWO EXAMPLES

D above C (the root of Cmaj7)

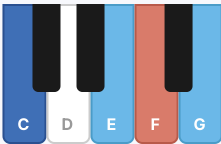
Is D a whole step or half step above C?



C → C# → D = **WHOLE STEP** above C → 9 is **Available** ✓

F above E (the 3rd of Cmaj7)

Is F a whole step or half step above E?



E → F = **HALF STEP** above E (3rd) → F (4th) is **Avoid** ✗